Chinmay Bhansali

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Research Interests

Core Areas: Human-Computer Interaction, Human-AI Interaction, Computational Design Evaluation
Focus: Evaluation methods for AI-mediated design workflows, cognitive misalignment in AI-generated interfaces, how non-UX professionals make interface decisions using generative tools

Education

University of British Columbia Vancouver, BC
Bachelor of Science in Integrated Sciences *September 2022 – May 2026*
Concentrations: Computer Science, Psychology, Mathematics (HCI)
Awards: Distinction; Swami Vivekanand Scholarship for Academic Excellence (full tuition coverage for 4 years)

Research Experience

Social, Collaborative, and Inclusive User Systems (SOCIUS) Lab – Volunteer Researcher *May 2026 – August 2026*
Conducting a solo research project under the supervision of Prof. Dongwook Yoon on designing an AI use policy framework for students, calibrated to the requirements of different instructors and departments across a university.

- **Policy Design:** Designing AI use policies that account for divergent instructor and departmental requirements, building a framework adaptable to diverse institutional contexts.
- **User Research:** Designing and conducting user studies to evaluate how students and instructors understand and navigate AI use policies across different course contexts.
- **Licensing:** Researching Creative Commons licensing frameworks to determine appropriate open licensing policy outputs, enabling adoption across institutions.

Sensory Perception & Interaction (SPIN) Lab – Research Assistant *October 2025 – April 2026*
Worked with Rocco Ruan (PhD student) on "Play Together, Feel Together," investigating technology-mediated social touch in multiplayer games using Sony TOIO robots.

- **Prototyping:** Developed Unity-based multiplayer game prototypes incorporating Sony TOIO robots to facilitate remote social touch interactions, implementing new game features and mechanics to explore design variations for user studies.
- **User Study Support:** Co-designed user studies to evaluate how people respond to different technology-mediated touch designs, including developing study protocols, and creating psychometric questionnaires.

Teaching Experience

UBC Department of Computer Science – Teaching Assistant, CPSC 344 *May 2026 – August 2026*
Supporting delivery of Introduction to HCI Methods during the final stage of a major course renovation.

- **Workshops:** Creating workshop slides for all five weekly workshop sections and leading one of the sections.
- **Exams:** Co-designing the midterm and the final exams and their rubric with a graduate TA and managing exam administration including printing and scanning exams.
- **Curriculum:** Contributing to the final stages of a curriculum renovation that began in Summer 2025, updating course content, delivery and structure to maximize student learning as well as reflect current HCI research practices.

Selected Writing

"The Trail Nobody Asked For" – LinkedIn Article *April 2026*
Published article on how AI-generated interfaces encode design decisions no one chose, built around a usability incident in which an AI-built prototype added an unrequested drag trail that a trained UX team failed to catch.

Selected Projects

GoodTimers – Advanced HCI Research Project (CPSC 444) *January 2026 – April 2026*

Researcher and Designer. *Full HCI research pipeline from need finding through controlled experiment, designing and evaluating a mobile application for planning between-lecture walks at UBC. Received two CPSC 444 showcase awards: Best at Catching "Sneaky Factors" and Most Comprehensive Construction (the only team to receive two awards).*

- **Need Finding & Design:** Conducted field study identifying that student break dissatisfaction stemmed from planning overhead rather than lack of activities; contributed to design requirements and evaluation of four design alternatives before converging on a walk-route generation approach.
- **Cognitive Walkthrough:** Participated in collaborative cognitive walkthrough of low-fidelity prototype, identifying confirmation and proceeding actions as the primary weak point in the design's feedback structure; findings directly shaped the medium-fidelity prototype scope.
- **Prototyping:** Designed Figma mockups and built the medium-fidelity web prototypes (HTML, CSS, JavaScript; Webstorm with Gemini) used in the actual experiment after Figma proved insufficient for the drag interaction; during implementation, the AI-assisted coding produced a visual drag trail not present in the original Figma design, which generated user confusion in the pilot study and required redesign.
- **Experiment Design and Analysis & Findings:** Co-designed a 3×2 split-plot controlled study ($N = 12$); applied ART ANOVA and Wilcoxon signed-rank tests; PDS significantly reduced cognitive load relative to baseline ($\eta^2 = 0.69$).

Food Manager – HCI Research Project (CPSC 344) *September 2025 – December 2025*

Lead Researcher and Qualitative Data Analyst*. Designed and evaluated a mobile application for reducing household food waste through a full user-centered design process. Received the People's Choice Award.*

- **User Research:** Conducted formative research ($N = 11$) using semi-structured interviews and affinity diagramming to identify user needs regarding household food waste and inventory tracking.
- **Iterative Design:** Piloted low-fidelity prototypes to validate interaction flows, utilizing findings to evolve the conceptual model from a Conveyor to a Factory metaphor before refining the final design into a medium-fidelity Figma prototype.
- **Usability Testing:** Designed and executed a mixed-methods summative evaluation ($N = 11$) utilizing think-aloud protocols and post-study questionnaires to assess interface efficiency, visibility, and integration.
- **Data Analysis:** Performed mixed-methods analysis by triangulating quantitative metrics including click-counts and Likert scales with qualitative insights from thematic analysis and observation notes to diagnose interaction bottlenecks.

Bnuuy's Ship – 2D Game Engine (Team Project) *January 2025 – April 2025*

Collaborated in a team of five to develop a 2D action-adventure game using C++ and OpenGL, implementing an ECS (Entities, Components and Systems)-based game engine architecture, enhancing modularity and scalability.

- Architecture-level decisions around entity state and collision propagation directly shaped moment-to-moment player experience, demonstrating how engineering choices become interaction design variables before any designer intervenes.

Technical Skills

Languages: C/C++, Java, C#, Python, R, SQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript.
Tools & Frameworks: Figma, Git, GitHub, Unity, Google Colab, Jupyter Notebook, TensorFlow, Flask, Bootstrap, MediaPipe, ECS.

Extracurricular Activities

Sargam UBC – Singer, Pianist, and Music Arranger *September 2023 – Present*

Sole pianist and lead vocalist for the annual Raagini concert; music arranger for two years.